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UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED, SHARIF DISCUSS WAYS TO STRENGTHEN TIES

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan meets Shehbaz Sharif, Prime Minister of Pakistan, at Nur Khan Air Base in Pakistan during an official reception. The leaders held talks on strengthening cooperation between the two countries, particularly in the fields of economy, investment, and development, in a way that serves mutual interests and advances their shared vision for progress and prosperity.

Djokovic, Pacquiao headline summit

Star-studded lineup of speakers at Dubai's World Sports Summit

DUBAI
BY JAI PRASAD V. RAI
Assistant Editor

Dubai is gearing up to host the World Sports Summit today and tomorrow at Madinat Jumeirah, organised by the Dubai Sports Council under the guidance of Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council.

Ahead of the event, Sheikh Hamdan highlighted Dubai's commitment to the positive impact of sport on societies worldwide. "Through this first-of-its-kind event in the UAE, we seek to empower communities, attract talent, and shape the future of sport worldwide," he said.

Who's who of sports

Tennis great Novak Djokovic, Fifa president Gianni Infantino, Arab tennis trailblazer Ons Jabeur and Brazilian football icon Ronaldo Nazario are among the headline speakers today.

Djokovic will reflect on the longevity that has helped him

secure a record 24 Grand Slam titles, while fellow tennis stars Jabeur and Paula Badosa will take part in a joint panel during the afternoon session.

Boxing legend Manny Pacquiao from the Philippines will share his journey from a challenging childhood to becoming the world's only eight-division champion.

Day two will be equally star-studded, featuring former UFC champion Khabib Nurmagomedov alongside a host of football greats, including Roberto Baggio, Cafu, Didier Deschamps, Carles Puyol, Fabio Cannavaro, Andrés Iniesta and Alessandro Del Piero.

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Dubai ready for seamless NYE celebrations

CROWD MANAGEMENT, TRANSPORT AND EMERGENCY SERVICES IN PLACE

DUBAI
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

Dubai authorities have confirmed the full readiness of the security and operational plan for New Year's Eve celebrations, ensuring public safety, smooth mobility and seamless services across all major celebration sites.

Security and emergency personnel

As part of the plan:

- 9,884 Dubai Police personnel to be deployed, supported by 1,625 security patrols and 36 bicycles.
- Marine and coastal zones will be secured with 53 rescue boats, 34 rescue platforms, and 37 support tents.
- 1,754 Civil Defence personnel and 165 fire engines will be on standby.
- 635 paramedics and 236 ambulances will provide medical readiness, supported by 12 nearby hospitals and clinics. Additionally, 1,900 medical professionals, 3,475 Dubai Municipality staff, and 13,502 private security personnel will assist operations. Also, 18,000 limousine vehicles are allocated for transportation needs.

Crowd management

To ensure smooth movement, authorities have allocated:

- 107 Metro trains, 1,300 public buses, and 14,000 taxis.
- 5,565 Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) staff.

Operations rooms to function 24/7, with dedicated emergency numbers (999, 901, 998) for immediate response.

Dubai Ambulance

Dubai Ambulance has deployed 635 personnel and 236 coverage points across Dubai and Hatta to ensure rapid medical response.

- The fleet includes specialised ambulances, rapid response units, electric and pedal bicycles, golf carts, field support units, marine rescue boats, and two ambulance buses.
- Air ambulance services will be available in coordination with Dubai Police.
- Teams will cover high-density areas, coastal zones, tourist spots, fireworks locations, and desert venues, ensuring swift response to emergencies.

Fireworks

Dubai authorities have approved 40 locations for 48 fireworks displays, including Burj Khalifa, Downtown Dubai, Palm Jumeirah, Dubai Festival City, Dubai Creek Harbour, Bluewaters, Burj Al Arab, Expo City Dubai, Global Village, Atlantis The Palm, and Palm Jebel Ali.

Dubai Metro services will continue with increased frequency at key stations near celebration sites. The RTA has also announced road closures in stages around Downtown Dubai to manage traffic and ensure safety.

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